

Santiago (Tigo) Ponce de León

Product Design Engineer

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EDUCATION

University of Chicago — B.A. Media Arts & Design and Computer Science

Coursework: Human-Computer Interaction, Internet Art & Web Design, Visual Systems

Honors: Spain Foreign Language Acquisition Grant — study in Madrid, Summer 2025

Expected May 2027
Chicago, IL

EXPERIENCE

Vicino AI — UX Engineer Intern

- Designed product experiences across key workflows for an AI-powered video and marketing platform, turning agentic creative concepts into user-centered interfaces.
- Built front-end UI components in React, bridging Figma designs and production code to accelerate design-to-engineer handoff.
- Shaped and documented the platform's visual language and interaction patterns into a scalable component library used across feature pages.

Jun 2026 - Aug 2026
Bellevue, WA

PantryPal — Product Designer and iOS Developer

- Designed and built an AI mobile app that turns the ingredients a household already owns into personalized recipes, cutting food waste through inventory reuse.
- Shipped the production iOS app to the App Store in Swift and SwiftUI — designing and coding the same screens.
- Ran user interviews and usability tests between design rounds, and built the system they fed: wireframes through high-fidelity UI, now implemented in SwiftUI.

Nov 2025 - Present
Chicago, IL



App Store
apple.co/3SprtQ8

University of Chicago — UX Researcher

- Ran an empirical study of visual and interaction patterns across six AI-generated recipe web apps to measure interface homogenization.
- Deployed prototypes via GitHub Pages and authored the paper on how AI models operationalize a statistical consensus of product design convention.

Nov 2025 - Dec 2025
Chicago, IL

Next Level Drone Cleaning — Founding Visual Designer

- Designed the complete visual identity for an early-stage drone-tech startup from scratch: brand guidelines, logo suite, and collateral across web, print, and pitch.
- Built the responsive marketing site (nextleveldronecleaning.be) with the founder, plus component libraries that held the team consistent without ongoing design help.

Jul 2025 - Sep 2025
Kortrijk, Belgium

SKILLS

product	User Research, Wireframing, Interaction Design, Design Systems, Usability Testing
engineering	Swift, SwiftUI, React, HTML / CSS / JavaScript, Python, Git, Xcode
design	Figma, Prototyping, Adobe Creative Cloud
languages	Spanish — professional working, English — fluent